MR. LIFE MANAGER · FREE GUIDE

Six Meals and a Stocked Kitchen

Enough to stop deciding what's for dinner every single night.

01 The pattern underneath all of it

Almost every simple dinner is the same four slots. Learn the shape and you can improvise forever without a recipe.

Something filling + **Something with protein** + **Something green** + **Something with flavor**

Rice, pasta, potatoes, bread, tortillas — plus eggs, chicken, beans, ground meat, cheese, canned fish — plus whatever vegetable you have — plus sauce, spice, butter, lemon, soy, hot sauce. Swap any slot. It still works.

WHY THIS MATTERS MORE THAN THE RECIPES

A recipe tells you what to do once. The pattern tells you what to do when you're missing an ingredient, which is most nights. It's als... what lets you shop without a meal plan and still eat.

02 The six

All under 30 min

Make each one three times and you'll stop needing to read it.

ONE

Pasta, properly

Salt the water heavily — it should taste like the sea. Cook the pasta one minute less than the box says. Save a mug of the water before draining, then stir a splash into the sauce and pasta together in the pan.

That mug of starchy water is the whole trick. It turns sauce and pasta into one thing instead of two.

TWO

Eggs, three ways

Scrambled: low heat, keep them moving, take them off while still slightly wet. Fried: medium, lid on for a minute. Omelette: beat, pour, tilt, fold when the top is nearly set.

Low and slow is the answer to almost every egg problem. High heat is why they go rubbery.

THREE

Rice bowl

Rice, plus whatever protein you have, plus a vegetable, plus a sauce. Fried egg on top makes almost any version better.

The most forgiving meal there is. It's designed for leftovers.

FOUR

Stir fry

Pan as hot as you dare. Protein first, out. Hard vegetables, then soft. Protein back in, sauce last, thirty seconds. Serve on rice.

Everything chopped *before* you turn the heat on. There is no time once it starts.

FIVE

Tacos or a burrito bowl

Brown ground meat or warm a can of black beans. Season generously. Tortillas or rice, plus cheese, salsa, whatever's in the fridge.

Season the meat more than feels right. Under-seasoning is why home cooking tastes flat.

SIX

Grilled cheese and tomato soup

Butter the outside of the bread, not the pan. Medium-low heat, lid on, flip once. Patience is the whole recipe.

High heat burns the bread before the cheese melts. This is the only mistake available.

03 The stocked kitchen

If these are in the house, you can make something on a night you didn't plan for. That's the entire point of a stocked kitchen.

PANTRY — BUY ONCE, REPLACE WHEN OUT

- Cooking oil — olive and a neutral one
- Pasta and rice
- Canned beans
- Soy sauce
- Garlic
- Dried herbs — oregano, red pepper flakes
- Hot sauce
- Honey or sugar
- Salt and black pepper
- Canned tomatoes
- Bouillon cubes or powder
- Vinegar — any kind
- Onions
- Paprika and cumin
- Peanut butter
- Flour

FRIDGE AND FREEZER

- Eggs
- Milk
- Lemons
- Frozen protein — chicken thighs, ground meat
- Mustard and mayonnaise
- Butter
- Cheese — something hard, something that melts
- Frozen vegetables — peas, spinach, mixed
- Bread — freeze half the loaf
- Something green that keeps: carrots, cabbage

> **FROZEN VEGETABLES ARE NOT A COMPROMISE**
>
> They're frozen within hours of picking, they don't rot in the drawer, and they cost less. Fresh is better for things you eat raw. For… anything cooked, frozen is genuinely fine — and it's the difference between having a vegetable and not.

04 Shopping so the food gets eaten

- **Check the fridge before you go.** Two minutes, and it's what keeps you from buying a third jar of mustard.
- **Pick three or four meals** for the week — not seven. You'll eat out, or repeat, or not feel like it.
- **Buy perishables for two or three days**, not seven. Fresh food bought on Sunday for Friday is food you're throwing away.
- **Keep a running list** — on the fridge or your phone — and add things when you notice, not when you shop.
- **Don't shop hungry.** It's a cliché because it's true and it costs real money.

THE MISTAKE EVERYONE MAKES IN WEEK ONE

Aspirational shopping. You buy for the person who cooks four fresh meals a week, and then you're the person you actually are, and... half of it rots. **Buy for the cook you are right now.** Grow the list once you're actually cooking.

05 Clean as you cook

This is what decides whether you cook again tomorrow.

- **Fill the sink with hot soapy water before you start.** Things go in as you finish with them.
- **Wash while things simmer.** There's always four minutes of standing around.
- **Wipe the counter while the pan's still hot.** Wet is ten seconds; dried is three minutes.
- **Deal with the pan before you sit down.** Soak it at minimum.
- **Aim to sit down to a clean kitchen.** It sounds fussy and it's the entire game.

THE LOOP THAT ENDS IN TAKEOUT

Dirty kitchen → cooking feels like a chore → you order in → money gone and the kitchen is still dirty. It compounds fast. **The ten minutes after dinner is the cheapest place to break it.**

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